

Thorne Blackreed – Character Backstory

Origins: The Forest That Forgot the Sun

Thorne was born under a canopy of green and gold in the now-lost woodlands of Velthamar, a forest once believed sacred. His father, Caidan Blackreed, was a famed tracker among the border clans—a grim but respected man who could kill with a glance and vanish like smoke. His mother, Ylenia Vaelor, was a half-elf apothecary from the twilight cities of Idris, keeper of old songs and forgotten spirits.

From them, Thorne inherited survival skills and soul-deep intuition. He learned to see without looking. To walk without sound. And to listen to the things others tried not to hear.

Velthamar had always been strange—trees that whispered your name, ponds that reflected your past. But when the blight came, it changed. Leaves bled black. Wolves forgot how to die. Travelers vanished—and the ones who came back wore other people's faces.

Thorne was fourteen when he first saw his mother cry. Not from fear—but because the forest began praying to something else.

Then the sickness came.

The Long Nightfall

When the Carrion King's influence crept into Idris, it didn't march. It settled. Like fog. Like rot.

The priests stopped hearing their gods. The druids burned their own groves. Caidan and Ylenia prepared to flee... but the forest didn't let them.

One night, Thorne woke to screaming. Not outside—the kind that came from inside your mind. Visions of flame. Ash. A horned figure of bone and shadow dragging a chain of ghosts behind it.

He ran. He didn't pack. Didn't look back.

He never saw his parents again.

A Decade in the Dark

For the next ten years, Thorne survived the ruins of Idris. Sleeping in collapsed watchtowers. Eating what he could catch. Fighting off ferals, beasts, and things that crawled out of mist.

He was a boy who learned to become less than human to survive. A thing that could disappear. That killed without sound. That buried bodies and remembered their names.

The whispers started around then.

Spirits. Memories. Dreams that weren't his.

He stopped wondering why.

The Exodus to Yorin

By 27, Thorne made it to the shores of Yorin. He didn't come as a savior, or even a refugee. He came because nothing had tried to kill him in a week, and that was new.

He tried to live quietly in the city of Skive—a shadow among shadows. Watching. Listening. Taking jobs that required no questions and fewer witnesses.

But Yorin isn't untouched.

The blight is here too.

The whispers say the All Mother is faltering.

The stars over Skive flicker.

And Thorne is so very tired.

But something in him—something stubborn, broken, human—isn't ready to let the last light go out.

Roleplay Hooks and Secrets

- Whispered Companion: Thorne is haunted by the spirit of Nira, a young girl whose death he could not prevent. She speaks to him in dreams and sometimes takes control of his body in moments of stress. Is she a ghost? Or part of his fractured mind?
- The Blight Mark: A patch of shadowed skin over his heart pulses faintly when undead are near. He keeps it hidden.
- Survivor's Guilt: He blames himself for leaving his parents. He sometimes seeks out situations that might end him, half-hoping someone else gets to live because of it.
- The Lost Song: Ylenia taught him a lullaby in Elvish. He sings it quietly when alone. It's the last piece of his family he remembers.

The One Who Forgot Him

Thorne had a younger sister once.

Her name was Caela.

She was five years younger—fierce, talkative, the kind of child who made friends with moss and gave names to every bird. While Thorne was learning to move through the woods like a shadow, Caela sang to it. Ylenia swore the trees listened more to Caela than they ever did to her.

When the rot came, their parents made a desperate choice. They sent Caela away, deeper into the forest, toward an old elven waystation rumored to be protected. Thorne wanted to

go with her. Caidan said no. “You stay. She’s the hope. You’re the sword.”

Thorne stayed.

The forest burned a week later.

He assumed she died. But he never found a body. Never found a trace.

Years Later...

In the ruins of Idris, years into his exile, Thorne encountered a young woman.

She was pale. Her eyes too wide, too old. She moved like she was listening to a different rhythm than the world around her.

She didn’t remember him. But he remembered her birthmark. And the way she hummed when she was afraid.

She called herself Lira now.

And she served something she called “the Gray Choir.” Something that whispered from dead trees and taught her how to command bones.

She didn’t remember Velthamar. Or her parents. Or him.

Thorne didn’t kill her.

But he didn’t save her, either.

He just left her... standing in the snow, whispering to birds that weren’t there.

How It Shaped Him

- He carries Caela’s old hair ribbon, now gray with age. He doesn’t wear it. He just... has it.
- When someone forgets his name, he doesn’t correct them.
- His greatest fear is not death—it’s being erased.